EduTap

SEBI Grade A

Comprehensive Guide Book

Start Your Journey Here

Preface

This comprehensive guide is your go-to resource for understanding, preparing, and excelling in the SEBI Grade A examination. Designed by experienced mentors, this guide brings together everything you need from syllabus, exam pattern, eligibility, and resources to previous cut-offs, job profile, salary, perks, and much more.

Without such clarity, aspirants often find themselves confused about the exact structure of the exam, its phases, subjects, and marking scheme. This confusion can lead to an unfocused preparation strategy, wasted time, and unreliable information from scattered sources. Having all accurate and updated details in one place will help you prepare in the right direction with confidence.

This guidebook covers everything you must know about SEBI and the Grade A exam, including:

- Exam notifications and historic data
- Job profile, roles, perks, and career growth at SEBI
- Eligibility, pattern, and syllabus
- Last 5 years' cut-offs and exam analysis
- Resources for every subject and interview
- Study plan & Tips

By exploring these sections in detail, this guide will help you gain a complete understanding of the exam as well as life as a SEBI Grade A officer — from preparation to posting.

Whether you're a first-time aspirant or someone improving your strategy, this guide will serve as your trusted roadmap to success.

Wishing you the very best in your journey to becoming a SEBI Grade A officer.

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Part 1

SEBI Grade A Notification

1. Notification 🔔

Understanding the timeline of notifications, vacancies, and exam dates is essential for effective preparation.

1.1 Notification Years and Dates 🗓️

Here is a quick reference of the **last 4 recruitment cycles**, covering the release date of notification, number of vacancies, and Phase 1 & 2 exam dates.

SEBI Grade A Notification Timeline (2020–2025)						
Year	**Notification Release**	**Phase 1 Exam**	**Phase 1 Result**	**Phase 2 Exam**	**Phase 2 Result**	**Final Result**
2020 - 21	7 Mar 2020	17 Jan 2021	28 Jan 2021	27 Feb 2021	18 Mar 2021	14 Jul 2021
2022 - 23	5 Jan 2022	20 Feb 2022	25 Feb 2022	20 Mar 2022	7 Apr 2022	11 Jul 2022
2024 - 25	11 Jun 2024	27 Jul 2024	7 Aug 2024	31 Aug 2024	10 Oct 2024	4 Jan 2025
2025 - 26	30 Oct 2025	10 Jan 2026	To be announced	21 Feb 2026	To be announced	To be announced

Key Takeaways 📝

- The gap between the **notification and the Phase 1 exam** is usually **46 - 72 days**. However, in the 2020-21 cycle, Phase 1 was delayed due to the pandemic and happened after **136 days.**
- The **Phase 1 result** is usually declared **within 1–2 weeks**, with an average of **9 days** across cycles.
- The gap between **Phase 1 and Phase 2** is about **35 days**, giving candidates roughly **5 weeks** to prepare for the next stage.
- The **Phase 2 results** are announced in about **3–4 weeks**, with an average of **26 days**.
- The **final result** takes the longest and is released after **about 4 months** on average.
- SEBI earlier followed a **22-month gap** between notifications (2020, 2022, 2024). But the **2025 notification came only 16 months after 2024.**

1.2 Number of Vacancies

The number of vacancies has shown **fluctuations in recent years:**

SEBI Grade A Number of Vacancies & Applications					
Year	**Total Vacancies**	**Total Applications Received**	**Total Appeared Applicants - Phase 1**	**Total Students Cleared Phase 1**	**Total Appeared Applicants - Phase 2**
2020 - 21	147	88586	40560	15037	12351
2022 - 23	120	54511	33645	9237	6116
2024 - 25	97	38166	24870	6211	4572
2025 - 26	135	To be announced	To be announced	To be announced	To be announced

1.3 Key Takeaways

- Based on the last few cycles, the **highest** number of vacancies was in **2020–21** with **147 seats**, while the **lowest** was in **2024–25** with **97 seats**.
- General-stream vacancies were **80** (2020–21), **80** (2022–23), **62** (2024–25) and **77** (2025–26) as per official notifications.
- **Applications received** fell from **88,586 (2020–21)** to **38,166 (2024–25)** — showing that fewer aspirants are applying each year.

Phase 1 Attendance:

- In **2020–21**, only **40,560** out of **88,586** applicants appeared — about **46%** showed up.
- In **2022–23**, **33,645** out of **54,511** appeared — around **62%** attendance.
- In **2024–25, 24,870** out of **38,166** appeared — about **65%** attendance.
- This means **only 45–65% of total applicants** are serious enough to appear for the exam.

Phase 2 Attendance:

- As you can clearly see in the table, many students who clear Phase 1 do **not** appear for Phase 2.
    - In **2020–21, 15,037** students cleared Phase 1, but only **12,351** appeared for Phase 2 — a drop of **2,686 students**.
    - In **2022–23, 9,237** cleared Phase 1, but only **6,116** appeared for Phase 2 — a drop of **3,121 students**.
    - In **2024–25, 6,211** cleared Phase 1, but only **4,572** appeared for Phase 2 — a drop of **1,639 students**.
- On average, **20% to 35%** of students who qualify Phase 1 do **not** appear for Phase 2.
- This means your **actual competition becomes lower** at the Phase 2 stage, because a significant portion of qualified candidates do not sit for the exam.

Overall Competition:

- Considering serious aspirants (those who actually appear), there's a competition of roughly **73–76 candidates per seat.**

1.4 Next Notification Details / Rumours

- The **2025–26 notification came earlier than expected**, arriving only **16 months** after the 2024–25 cycle. This is much quicker than SEBI's earlier pattern, where notifications were released every **20–22 months** (2020–21→2022–23→2024–25).
- So, based on the current trend, the next announcement can be expected in the **last quarter of 2026.**

Part 2

SEBI Grade A Job Profile, Salary & Lifestyle

2. SEBI Grade A Officer Job 💼

Before preparing for the exam, every aspirant should clearly understand what the SEBI Grade A Officer job involves, the roles and responsibilities, departments they'll handle, salary, tax deductions, allowances, perks, training, postings, transfers, and promotion structure.

Knowing these details helps you stay motivated and plan your career journey with clarity.

2.1 Role/Responsibilities of SEBI Assistant Manager 👨‍💼

As a Grade A Officer, you play a key role in regulating and developing India's securities market, handling responsibilities across multiple functions such as:

- **Market Surveillance:** Monitoring market activities for irregularities, insider trading, and other fraudulent practices.
- **Regulatory Compliance:** Ensuring that market participants adhere to SEBI regulations and guidelines.
- **Investigations:** Conducting investigations into suspected violations of securities laws.
- **Policy Formulation:** Assisting in the development and implementation of new regulations and policies.
- **Investor Protection:** Protecting the interests of investors and ensuring a fair and transparent market.
- **Data Analysis:** Analyzing market data and trends to identify potential risks and opportunities.
- **Corporate Governance:** Promoting good corporate governance practices among listed companies.
- **International Coordination:** Collaborating with international regulatory bodies.

Important Note: The role and responsibilities of a SEBI Grade A officer depend on the department to which they are assigned. The departments are assigned as per SEBI requirements.

2.2 Salary & Allowances 💸

A SEBI Grade A Officer receives a monthly gross salary of **₹1,84,632**, which amounts to **approximately ₹22.16 lakh annually (excluding perks and benefits)**.

In addition, SEBI officers receive several allowances and benefits that can add **around ₹5 lakh per year** to the total compensation, depending on eligibility.

Please note that the exact in-hand salary may vary from person to person depending on location, tax regime, and the allowances actually availed.

2.2.1 In-Hand Salary 💸

Here's what you take home after deductions (like NPS and taxes):

SEBI Grade A Officer Salary Monthly Earnings	
Component	**Amount (₹)**
Basic Salary	62,500
Special Allowance	17,063
Grade Allowance	14,300
Dearness Allowance (DA)	20,531
Family Allowance	2,500
House Allowance	41,700
Local Allowance	3,125
Special Comp. Allowance	500
Learning Allowance	3,300
Employer NPS Contribution	16,015
Total Gross Monthly Salary	**1,84,632**

2.2.2 Monthly Deductions

Deduction	Amount (₹)
Employee NPS Contribution	13,727
Employer NPS Contribution	16,015
Medical Assistance Fund	360
Professional Tax	200
Income Tax	21,717
Lunch	100
Staff Association	200
Total Monthly Deductions	**52,319**

2.2.3 Net Take-Home Salary

₹1,84,632 (Gross) – ₹52,319 (Deductions) = ₹1,22,313 (Net Take-Home)

This is the **approximate monthly in-hand salary** for a SEBI Grade A officer.
It may vary slightly for each individual depending on tax regime, accommodation, and personal allowances availed.

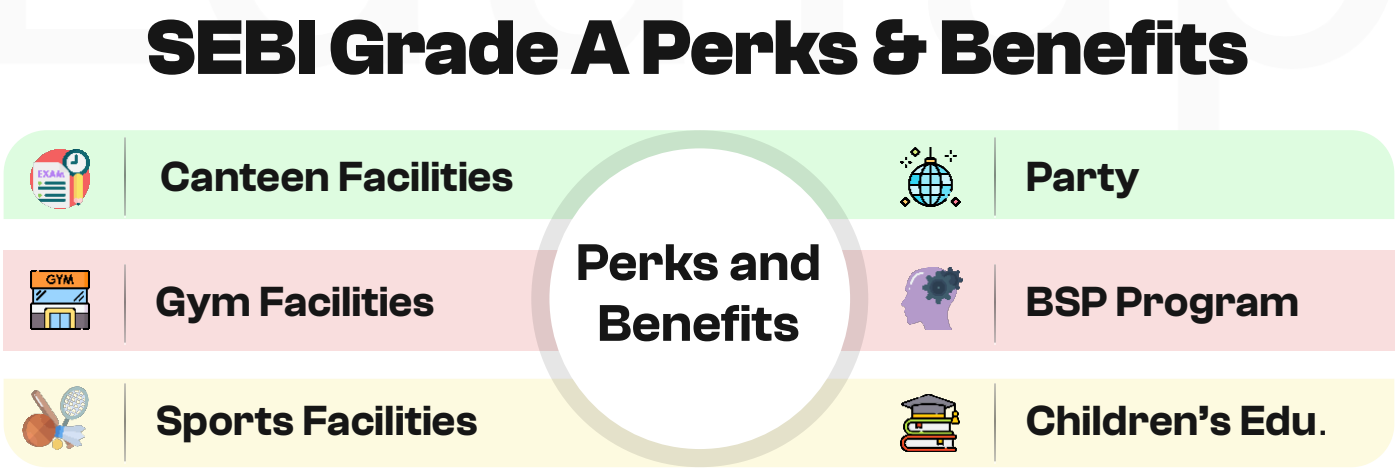
2.2.4 Allowances

Apart from salary, SEBI Grade A officers receive several allowances and benefits.
Since exact figures vary from person to person and you have not provided specific monthly values, a consolidated annual estimate is mentioned:

- Officers receive **additional allowances and benefits worth approximately ₹5 lakh per year.**
- These include housing benefits, reimbursements, educational support, and other financial perks depending on eligibility and location.

2.3 Additional Perks & Benefits

- SEBI has excellent canteen facilities and by paying just ₹100, you can have lunch for the whole month.
- There are free gym facilities to keep yourself fit.
- For sports enthusiasts, SEBI keeps organizing cricket, badminton, etc. tournaments. Also, sports kits are reimbursed.
- They also have a budget of ₹5000 per employee per 6 months to go out and enjoy.
- There is a BSP program, which is basically a brainstorming program and a budget of ₹11000 per year is allocated for it. The agenda of this program is to allow people to go out and brainstorm their strengths and weaknesses as a team and what can be done better in the organization.
- SEBI also pays up to ₹7000 per month for the education of your children. (up to 2 children)
- SEBI follows a 5-day work week with standard working hours from 9 AM to 6 PM. Employees get approximately 160 days off in a year, which includes 104 weekends, around 42 casual and other leaves, and about 15 national holidays.·



2.4 Training at SEBI

- After selection, you first attend a **6-week induction program** at the **National Institute of Securities Markets (NISM), Patalganga, Maharashtra**.
- The training covers **technical knowledge of the securities market** and **soft skill development** through behavioural sessions.
- After the induction, you begin **on-the-job training** and serve a **2-year probation period.**
- **Full salary is paid** during the entire training period.
- The **SEBI Head Office** is in **Mumbai,** with **Regional Offices** in **New Delhi, Chennai, Ahmedabad, and Kolkata**, etc., and **local offices** across other major cities.

2.5 Postings

Here is the posting policy of a SEBI Grade A officer:

- Most SEBI Grade A officers are initially posted at SEBI's headquarters in Mumbai, Maharashtra.
- SEBI does have regional offices in several key locations across India, including Delhi, Chandigarh, Bangalore, Chennai, Kolkata, and others.
- If you wish to be posted in your hometown, you may request the same to SEBI after joining.
- There are no rural postings in SEBI at all.
- SEBI does not have its office abroad, so you do not get posted abroad.
- You may get an opportunity to go on deputation to various other domestic regulatory bodies, Government departments, foreign regulatory bodies, multilateral organizations and other organizations relevant to the financial market.

2.6 Transfers

Here are some key points about the transfer policy of SEBI Grade A officers:

- Transfers typically occur after completing 5 years in a particular posting.
- Transfers can be to any SEBI office in India, including:
  - **Head Office:** Mumbai
  - **Regional Offices:** Northern Regional Office (NRO) - New Delhi, Southern Regional Office (SRO) - Chennai, Western Regional Office (WRO) - Ahmedabad, Eastern Regional Office (ERO) - Kolkata, etc.
  - **Local Offices:** Indore Local Office, Delhi, Chandigarh, Bangalore, Chennai, Kolkata, etc.

- Transfers are based on organizational needs and officer's experience and capabilities.
- Transfers may involve switching departments.

* The transfers in SEBI are not frequent due to the limited number of available options and positions.

2.7 Promotions

An officer can expect an interview call for the promotion within **3-5 years of service**.

The promotions in SEBI are time bound and based on your performance mentioned in the annual report and interview round.

The Executive Director, Whole-Time Director, and Chairman of SEBI are appointed by the Government of India, and these positions may also be filled by officials from other regulatory bodies.

2.8 Hierarchy

Once on board as an Assistant Manager (Grade A), the career progression begins, climbing from Assistant Manager to Chief General Manager.

SEBI Grade A Promotions

*Promotions also depend on the availability of vacancies

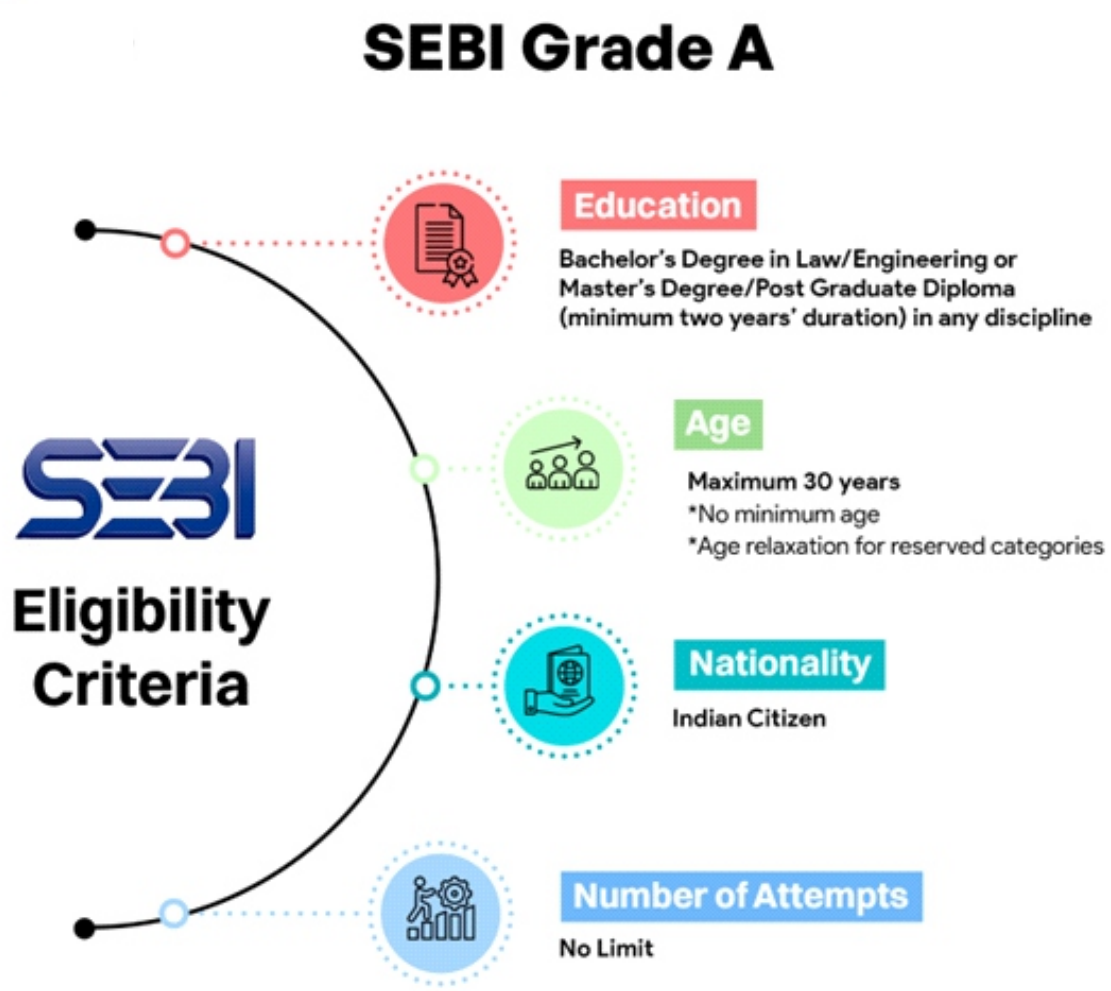
Part 3

SEBI Grade A Eligibility

3. Eligibility

The eligibility criteria for SEBI Grade A specifies the minimum educational qualifications, age limits, and requirements that candidates must meet.

While the official notification outlines these conditions in detail, we have summarised them clearly to help you quickly understand whether you qualify for the exam.



3.1 Age Limit & Relaxation

- The age for the SEBI Grade A exam is calculated as of the date mentioned in the respective year's official notification.
- There is no minimum age requirement for any category.
- The maximum age limit for the unreserved/general category is 30 years, with the eligible date of birth clearly specified in that year's notification.

For reserved categories, the details are given below:

SEBI Grade A

Maximum Age Limit and Relaxation

Category	Age Relaxation	Upper Age Limit
General	None	30
OBC	3 Years	33
SC/ST	5 Years	35
Ex-Servicemen	5 Years	35
PwD (General/EWS)	10 Years	40
PwD (OBC)	13 Years	43
PwD (SC/ST)	15 Years	45

3.2 Educational Qualification (General Stream)

- You can apply for a maximum of 2 streams, provided you meet the educational qualifications for each.
- You need to submit a separate online application for each stream with the corresponding fee.

SEBI GRADE A Eligibility

Educational Qualifications

Bachelor's degree in Law/Engineering

Master's degree/ postgraduate diploma (2 years) in any discipline

CA/ CFA/ CS /Cost Accountant

3.3 Nationality

According to the latest official SEBI Grade A assistant manager notification, only Indian citizens can apply for the exam.

3.4 Number of Attempts

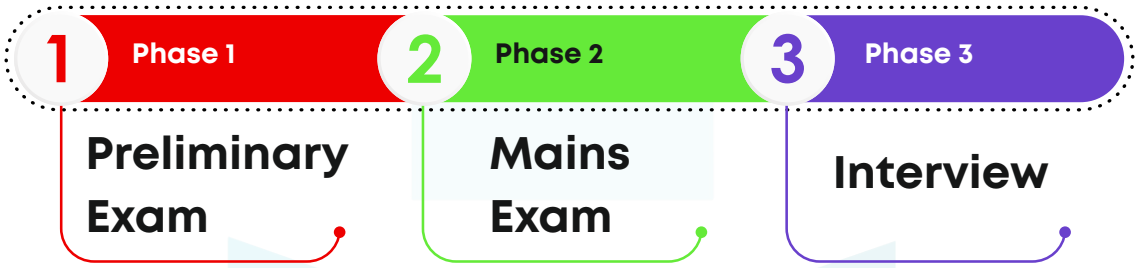
The official notification for the SEBI Grade A examination does not specify a maximum number of attempts. If candidates meet all the eligibility criteria, they are eligible to apply for the SEBI Grade A assistant manager exam.

Part 4

SEBI Grade A Exam Pattern

4. Pattern

Officers in Grade A cadre of the Securities and Exchange Board of India (SEBI) are recruited through a 3-stage recruitment process:



4.1 SEBI Grade A - Phase 1 Pattern

The Phase 1 (Prelims) examination is **qualifying in nature** and consists of **two papers**. Marks obtained in this stage are used **only for shortlisting candidates for Phase 2** and are **not considered for the final merit list.**

4.1.1 Phase 1 Paper 1

- Contains **multiple-choice questions** from **General Awareness** (including basic financial awareness), **English Language, Quantitative Aptitude**, and **Reasoning**.
- The paper carries **100 marks**, is to be completed in **60 minutes**, and consists of **80 questions.**
- Each section has **20 questions** for **25 marks**, contributing to the total of 100 marks.
- The **minimum cut-off** for Paper 1 is **30%** (there is no sectional cut-off).
- **Negative marking of 1/4th of the marks** assigned to each question is applicable.

SEBI Grade A Pattern Phase 1 Paper 1			
Section	**Questions**	**Marks**	**Duration**
General Awareness	20	25	60 minutes
English Language	20	25	
Quantitative Aptitude	20	25	
Reasoning	20	25	
Total	**80**	**100**	
Minimum Cut-Off –30%			

4.1.2 Phase 1 Paper 2 📄

- Consists of **multiple-choice questions** from specialized subjects.
    - **General Stream:** Commerce, Accountancy, Management, Finance, Costing, Companies Act, and Economics.
    - **Other Streams:** MCQs from subjects relevant to the specific stream (Legal, Research, IT, Engineering, etc.).
- The paper carries **100 marks** and must be completed in **40 minutes.**
- The **minimum cut-off** for Paper 2 is **40%**.
- **Negative marking of 1/4th** of the marks assigned to each question is applicable.

SEBI Grade A Pattern Phase 1 Paper 2 (General Stream)			
Section	**Questions**	**Marks**	**Duration**
Commerce & Accountancy	50 questions covering these 6 sections	100	40 minutes
Management			
Finance			
Costing			
Companies Act			
Economics			
Minimum Cut-Off –40%			

4.1.3 Overall Cut-off Requirement

- Candidates must secure:
-
    - The **individual cut-off in both Paper 1 (30%)** and **Paper 2 (40%)**, and
    - An **aggregate cut-off of 40%** across Phase 1.
- Only candidates meeting **all** the above criteria are shortlisted for **Phase 2**.
- For example: If a student scores **32 marks in Paper 1** and **38 marks in Paper 2**, their **total becomes 70 marks.**
    - Even though they have cleared the Paper 1 cut-off, they have not cleared the Paper 2 cut-off **(minimum required is 40 marks)** or the overall aggregate cut-off **(minimum required is 80 marks)**.

- As a result, this student will not qualify for Phase 2.

- In another case, if a student scores **35 marks in Paper 1** and **50 marks in Paper 2**, their **total becomes 85 marks**.
  - Since they have cleared the individual cut-offs for both papers as well as the overall cut-off, this student will be shortlisted for Phase 2.

SEBI GRADE A

General Stream - Phase 1 Pattern

Mode	Online
Paper Structure	MCQs
Nature	Qualifying
Language	Hindi & English (Except the test of English)
Questions	Paper 1: 80 Paper 2: 50
Marks	Paper 1: 100 Paper 2: 100
Sectional Cut-Offs	No
Duration	Paper 1: 60 minutes Paper 2: 40 minutes
Cut-Offs	Paper 1: 30% Paper 2: 40% Aggregate: 40%
Negative Marking	1/4th marks for every wrong answer Paper 1: 0.3125 marks Paper 2: 0.5 marks

4.2 SEBI Grade A 2025 - Phase 2 Pattern

Candidates who qualify Phase 1 will be issued **fresh hall tickets** for Phase 2. Phase 2 consists of **two papers**, and marks obtained in this stage are used for **shortlisting candidates for the Interview (Phase 3).**

- Candidates applying for **multiple streams** will have **Paper 2** conducted in **different shifts**, and the exact timings will be mentioned in the hall ticket.
- **Negative marking of 1/4th of the marks** assigned to each question applies to the MCQ-based portion of Paper 2.
- **Paper 1**
  - Carries **30% minimum cut-off**, as prescribed in the official notification.
  - Contributes **one-third (1/3rd)** to the overall Phase 2 aggregate.
- **Paper 2**
  - Carries a **40% minimum cut-off.**
  - Includes **MCQs**, with negative marking applicable.
  - Contributes **two-thirds (2/3rd)** to the overall Phase 2 aggregate.
  - **All papers,** except English, are **bilingual (Hindi & English)**.
- **Candidates must secure:**
  - The **individual cut-off** in both Paper 1 **(30%**) and Paper 2 **(40%)**, and
  - An **aggregate of 50%** across both papers.
- Based on the **Phase 2 aggregate**, candidates meeting all cut-off conditions will be **shortlisted for the Interview**.
- The number of candidates shortlisted will be **three times the number of vacancies**, arranged in order of merit.
- The final list of candidates shortlisted for the Interview will be published on the **SEBI website.**

SEBI Grade A 2025 Phase 2 Pattern				
Paper	**Stream/Subjects**	**Marks**	**Duration**	**Cut Off**
Paper 1	English (Descriptive Test) to test the drafting skills	100	60 Minutes	30%
Paper 2	Multiple choice questions on subjects Commerce, Accountancy, Management, Finance, Costing, Companies Act, and Economics.	100	90 Minutes	40%
Aggregate Cut-Off – 50%				

4.3 Changes in Phase 1 and Phase 2 Pattern (Across Cycles)

To give clarity on how the number of questions has changed across the recent cycles:

- In **2022**, Phase 1 Paper 2 and Phase 2 Paper 2 both consisted of **50 questions each.**
- In **2024**, Phase 1 Paper 2 had **50 questions**, but Phase 2 Paper 2 was **increased to 100 questions.**
- The **2025 notification** follows the **same pattern** as **2024**, with Phase 1 Paper 2 having 50 questions and Phase 2 Paper 2 having 100 questions.

4.4 SEBI Grade A Interview

The SEBI Grade A examination consists of an Interview.

- Candidates are shortlisted for interview based on their Phase 2 marks only (sum of 2 papers)
- Weightage of marks obtained in Phase 2 is 85%, while marks obtained in interview is given a weightage of 15%.
- Candidates can opt for interview either in Hindi or English

The final selection of candidates is done by adding marks secured in Phase 2 and Interview.

Part 5

SEBI Grade A Syllabus

5. Syllabus

The SEBI Grade A syllabus is structured across **Phase 1, Phase 2, and the Interview**.

While the official notification provides a broad, indicative list of topics, it can feel **too general for focused preparation.**

To help aspirants, we have **carefully collated a detailed syllabus by thoroughly analyzing previous years' question papers**, ensuring you know exactly what to prepare for each phase.

5.1 General Awareness

- National News: MoUs, summits, and major events related to India.
- International: Summits and conferences held abroad.
- Financial & Economics News
- Financial Awareness: SEBI and SEBI notification and regulations
- Defence: Military exercises, drills, and major updates related to the defence sector of India
- Days in News: Major events or days, along with its date and theme
- Persons in News: Obituaries, appointments, and retirements
- Sports: Major tournaments and its winners
- Science, Technology, and Space
- Awards and Honours
- Environment
- Banking and Economy Related News
- Reports and Government Schemes
- Books and Authors
- Chief Ministers and Cabinet Ministers
- National Parks and Sanctuaries
- Airport Locations, Stadiums
- Organisations' Headquarters
- Banks' Headquarters and Taglines
- Power Plants in India
- Indian Dance Forms
- Countries Capitals and their Currencies

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of General Awareness

MOST IMPORTANT	MODERATELY IMPORTANT	LEAST IMPORTANT
Sports	Appointments	Environment
First in News	Persons in News	Places in News
Science and Technology	MOUs and Agreements	Fairs and Festivals
Days in News	Summits and Conferences	Books and Authors
Banking and Finance		
Government Initiatives		
Awards		
Defense		

5.2 English

- Grammar
- Error Spotting
- Sentence Improvement
- Comprehension Ability
- Comprehension passage
- Cloze test
- Rearrangement
- Para jumbles
- Double Fillers
- Vocabulary – Synonyms, Antonyms, One-word Substitution, Phrasal Verbs

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of English

MOST IMPORTANT	MODERATELY IMPORTANT	LEAST IMPORTANT
Subject Verb Agreement	Cloze Test	Nouns
Tenses	Double Fillers	Modals
Complex Prepositions	Rearrangement	Articles
Reading Comprehension	Idioms & Phrases	Conditional Sentences
Word Reshuffle	Phrasal Verbs	
	Match the Column	

5.3 Quantitative Aptitude

- Ratio and Proportion
- Percentage
- Profit and Loss
- Simple and Compound Interest
- Average and Ages
- Time and Work
- Pipes and Cistern
- Time and Distance
- Mixture and Alligation
- Series and Quadratic Equation
- Mathematical Inequalities
- Number Series
- Data Interpretation
- Simplification/Approximation
- Quantity Comparisons
- Data Sufficiency
- Partnership

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Quant

★★★★★ MOST IMPORTANT	★★★ MODERATELY IMPORTANT	★★ LEAST IMPORTANT
• Number Series	• Profit and Loss	• Average
• Quadratic Equation	• Simple Interest	• Permutation & Combination
• Percentage	• Compound Interest	• Probability
• Ratio and Proportion	• Time and Work	• Mensuration 2D
• Data Interpretation	• Pipes and Cistern	• Mensuration 3D
• Partnership	• Time, Speed, and Distance	
• Ages	• Boats and Stream	
	• Allegation and Mixture	

5.4 Reasoning Ability

- Alphanumeric Series
- Coding and Decoding
- Syllogism
- Direction Sense
- Inequality
- Ranking and Order
- Blood Relation
- Puzzles
- Seating Arrangement
- Input-Output
- Critical Reasoning
- Questions Based on Data Sufficiency

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Reasoning

MOST IMPORTANT

- Alphanumeric Series
- Coding and Decoding
- Syllogism
- Inequality
- Direction Sense
- Blood Relation
- Ranking and Order

MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Seating Arrangement
- Puzzles

LEAST IMPORTANT

- Machine Input Output
- Statement Assumption
- Statement Argument
- Statement Conclusion
- Statement Cause and Effect
- Statement Course of Action
- Data Sufficiency

5.5 Commerce and Accountancy

- Accounting as a Financial Information System.
- Accounting Standards With Specific Reference to Accounting for Depreciation, Inventories, Revenue Recognition, Fixed Assets, Foreign Exchange Transactions, and Investments.
- Cash Flow Statement, Fund Flow Statement, Financial Statement Analysis; Ratio Analysis.
- Accounting for Share Capital Transactions Including Bonus Shares and Right Shares.
- Employees Stock Option and Buyback of Securities.
- Preparation and Presentation of Company Final Accounts.
- Introduction to Accountancy
- Theory Base of Accounting
- Recording Transaction Part 1
- Recording Transaction Part 2
- Trial Balance and Bills of Exchange

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Commerce & Accountancy

MOST IMPORTANT

- Ratio Analysis
- Cash Flow Statements
- Fund Flow Statements
- Basics of Accounting
- Presentation & Preparation of Company Final Accounts
- Schedule III
- Accounting Standard for: PPE
- Revenue Recognition
- Inventory
- Effect of Changes in Foreign Exchange Rate

MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Recording Transactions
- Accounting Standard for Investments
- Bonus Shares
- Buy Back
- Right Issue and ESOP
- Accounting for Share Capital

LEAST IMPORTANT

- Trial Balance and its Errors

5.6 Management

- Management: Its Nature and Scope; the Management Processes. Planning, Organization, Staffing, Directing, and Controlling.
- The Role of a Manager in an Organization. Leadership: The Tasks of a Leader.
- Leadership Styles: Leadership Theories; a Successful Leader Versus an Effective Leader.
- Human Resource Development: Concept of HRD; Goals of HRD
- Motivation, Morale, and Incentives: Theories of Motivation; How Managers Motivate; Concept of Morale; Factors Determining Morale; Role of Incentives in Building Up Morale.
- Communication: Steps in the Communication Process; Communication Channels; Oral Versus Written Communication; Verbal Versus Non-verbal Communication; Upward, Downward and Lateral Communication; Barriers to Communication, Role of Information Technology.

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Management

MOST IMPORTANT	MODERATELY IMPORTANT	LEAST IMPORTANT
• General Management • HRD • Motivation • Leadership	• Communication	• None

5.7 Finance

- Financial System: Role and Functions of Regulatory Bodies in the Financial Sector.
- Financial Markets: Primary and Secondary Markets (Forex, Money, Bond, Equity, Etc.), Functions, Instruments, and Recent Developments.
- General Topics
  - Basics of Derivatives: Forward, Futures, and Swap
  - Recent Developments in the Financial Sector
  - Financial Inclusion: Use of Technology
  - Alternate Source of Finance, Private and Social Cost-benefit, Public-private Partnership
  - Direct and Indirect Taxes: Non-tax Sources of Revenue, GST, Finance Commission, Fiscal Policy, Fiscal Responsibility and Budget Management Act(FRBM),
  - Inflation: Definition, Trends, Estimates, Consequences, and Remedies (Control): WPI, CPI-components, and Trends

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Finance

MOST IMPORTANT

- Primary and Secondary market - Debt Market
- Financial institutions
- Primary and Secondary market - Equity Market
- Bonds

MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Functions of SEBI
- Financial inclusion
- Forex Market
- Basics of Derivatives Options
- Basics of Derivatives Futures Forwards & Swaps
- Direct and Indirect taxes

LEAST IMPORTANT

- Finance commission
- GST
- Mutual Funds
- Alternate Sources of Finance

5.8 Costing

- Overview of Cost and Management Accounting: Introduction to Cost and Management Accounting, Objectives and Scope of Cost and Management Accounting.
- Methods of Costing: Single Output/ Unit Costing, Job Costing, Batch Costing, Contract Costing, Process/ Operation Costing, and Costing of Service Sectors.
- Basics of Cost Control and Analysis: (a) Standard Costing, (b) Marginal Costing, (c) Budget, and Budgetary Control.
- Lean System and Innovation:
  - Introduction to Lean System
  - Just-in-Time (JIT)
  - Kaizen Costing
  - 5 Ss
  - Total Productive Maintenance (TPM)
  - Cellular Manufacturing/ One-Piece Flow Production Systems

- Six Sigma (SS)
- Introduction to Process Innovation and Business Process Re-engineering (BPR)

5.9 Companies Act

- The Companies Act, 2013: Specific Reference to Chapter III, Chapter IV, Chapter VIII, Chapter X, Chapter XI, Chapter XII, and Chapter XXVII.
- Chapter IX Companies Act: Accounts of Company
- Chapter XIII Companies Act: Remuneration of Managerial Personnel
- Chapter I of Companies Act: Basics of Companies Act

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Companies Act

MOST IMPORTANT

- Chapter III: Prospectus & Allotment of Securities
- Chapter IV: Share Capital & Debentures
- Chapter VIII: Declaration & Payment of Dividend
- Chapter XXVII: NCLT & NCLAT

MODERATELY IMPORTANT

- Chapter XI: Appointment & Qualification of Directors
- Chapter XII: Meeting of Board and its Powers

LEAST IMPORTANT

- Chapter X: Audit & Auditors

5.10 Economics

- Demand and Supply, Market Structures, National Income: Concepts and Measurement, Classical Vs Keynesian Approach Determination of Output and Employment, Consumption Function, Investment Function, Multiplier and Accelerator, Demand and Supply for Money, IS-LM, Inflation and Phillips Curve, Business Cycles
- Balance of Payments, Foreign Exchange Markets, Inflation, Monetary and Fiscal Policy, Non-banking Financial Institutions

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Economics

★★★★★ MOST IMPORTANT	★★★ MODERATELY IMPORTANT	★★ LEAST IMPORTANT
• Demand and Supply • Market Structures • National Income: Concepts & Measurement • Demand & Supply for Money • IS - LM • Inflation and Phillips Curve • Business Cycles • Balance of Payments • Monetary and Fiscal Policy • Non-Banking Financial Institutions	• Classical & Keynesian Approach Determination of Output and Employment • Consumption Function • Investment Function • Multiplier and Accelerator	• Foreign Exchange Markets

5.11 Descriptive English

A. Essay

You have to choose one out of the 4-5 topics and write an essay of around 200 words. Listed below are some of the essays asked in the previous years.

- Importance of Teamwork in an Organization.
- Pros and Cons of Mergers and Acquisitions of Companies
- Role of Technology in Detecting and Preventing Financial Fraud
- Fake News and How to Identify It

B. Precis Writing

You have to **summarize a passage** of 400 to 600 words in approximately **170 to 180 words**. Usually, the precis comes from LiveMint, The Hindu, The Economic Times, Forbes magazine, etc.

C. Reading Comprehension

You need to answer 5 questions based on the given passage. Usually, the passage of reading comprehension comes from LiveMint, The Hindu, The Economic Times, Forbes magazine, etc.

SEBI Grade A

Important Topics of Descriptive English

Essay

- Economic & Social Issues (Women Empowerment, Global warming, Healthcare, etc.)
- Science & Technology (AI, Electric Cars, Web)
- Current affairs (G20 economy, Budget, etc.)
- Finance & Economy (Fin-tech, E Rupi, etc.)

Precis

- Topics range from day to day topics and are taken from articles/magazines

Reading Comprehension

- Topics range from day to day topics and are taken from articles/magazines

Part 6

SEBI Grade A Cut Off Marks & Analysis

6. Cut Off Marks

Knowing the SEBI Grade A cut-off marks for each stage over the last few exams helps you understand the competition and set clear score targets for every phase.

Below, you'll find the year-wise cut-off marks for Phase 1 and Phase 2, and the final cut-off along with a trend analysis to help you plan your preparation.

6.1 Last 3 Year Cut Off Marks Trends

- **Phase 1 (Prelims)** is qualifying in nature with fixed cut-offs:
  - **Paper 1**: Minimum 30% (30/100)
  - **Paper 2:** Minimum 40% (40/100)
- You need to **clear both papers separately and** secure an **overall 40% aggregate (80/200)** to move to Phase 2.
- **No sectional cut-off** applies in Phase 1.
- **Phase 2 (Mains)** has **2 papers of 100 marks each:**
  - **Paper 1**: 30% Cut off
  - **Paper 2**: 40% Cut off
  - Total Phase 2 score is calculated out of 100 using these weightages.
- **Final Selection:**
  - **Phase 2 contributes 85%** of the final score
  - **Interview contributes 15%**
  - Both Phase 2 and Interview scores are scaled to 100 based on their weightages.

6.1.1 SEBI Grade A 2020 Cut Off Marks

SEBI Grade A 2020 Cut Off Marks									
Stage	General	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PwBD			
						AU	VI	HI	LD/MD/OD
Phase 2	66	57.17	60.00	57.66	51.67	49	57.17	47.83	No Vacancy
Final	69.24	59.58	62.26	59.58	54.88	52.65	61.13	52.05	–

6.1.2 SEBI Grade A 2022 Cut Off Marks

SEBI Grade A 2022 Cut Off Marks									
Stage	General	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PwBD			
						LD	VI	HI	ID/MD
Phase 2	62.34	59.33	58.00	55.67	53.00	57	55	52.33	56
Final	64.82	59.00	57.58	57.32	55.87	60.58	58.75	58.85	54.60

6.1.3 SEBI Grade A 2024 Cut Off Marks

SEBI Grade A 2024 Cut Off Marks								
Stage	General	EWS	OBC	SC	ST	PwBD		
						Autism/ID/etc.	B&LV	OH
Phase 2	66.5	62.50	63.83	62.5	64.5	67	54	57
Final	69.30	64.72	65.75	62.87	62.425	-	55.05	59.55

6.2 Cut Off Analysis

- In **2020**, the exam was **moderate** in difficulty.
- In **2022**, Phase 2 Paper 2 consisted of 50 questions, each carrying 2 marks, contributing to a total of 100 marks. The **final cut-offs** were **lower** across most categories **compared to 2020.**
- In **2024**, Phase 2 Paper 2 was revised to 100 questions, each carrying 1 mark. After this change, the **final cut-offs increased** across all categories **compared to 2022.**
- Categories such as **OBC, EWS, SC, and ST** show a steady increase in cut-offs from 2020 to 2024, while the **Unreserved** category remained almost the same in 2020 and 2024.

SEBI Grade A Final Cut Off Comparative Analysis			
Category	**2020**	**2022**	**2024**
Unreserved	69.24	64.82	69.30
OBS	62.26	57.88	65.75
EWS	59.58	59.00	64.72
SC	59.58	57.32	62.87
ST	54.88	55.87	62.43

6.3 Key Takeaways

- Aim at least 5–7 marks above the previous year's final cutoff for safety.
- Every single mark matter because of negative marking.
- Careful selection of questions during the exam can improve your score significantly.
- Regular practice and timely revision help manage pressure and improve accuracy.
- Taking regular mocks is essential to evaluate preparation and exam readiness.

Part 7

SEBI Grade A Exam Analysis

7. Exam Analysis

The exam analysis section helps aspirants understand how the SEBI Grade A examination has evolved across different cycles.

By reviewing the structure of the papers, the number of questions, marking patterns, and the resulting cut-offs, aspirants can see how changes in the pattern have influenced performance trends over the years.

This analysis provides a clear view of what to expect and helps in planning a focused preparation strategy for the current cycle.

7.1 SEBI Grade A 2024 Phase 1 Exam Analysis

The SEBI Grade A 2024 Phase 1 (Prelims) exam was held on **27 July 2024**.

Based on the analysis, we can say that the overall difficulty level of the SEBI Grade A 2024 Phase 1 exam was **Easy to Moderate** compared to 2022 moderate to difficult level.

7.1.1 Reasoning Ability

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 reasoning difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Reasoning Ability: Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	6
Moderate	10
Difficult	4
Total	**20**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 reasoning topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Reasoning Ability: Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Seating Arrangement	8
Puzzle	4
Blood Relation	3
Alphabetical Series	2
Analytical Reasoning	2
Alphanumeric Series	1
Total	**20**

C. Key Takeaways

- The overall difficulty level of quant in 2024 was **moderate**, with only 2 difficult questions.
- Around 50% of the quant questions come from **data interpretation** (DI).
  - These types of questions are **time-consuming** and come in a set of 4 to 5 questions.
- **Quadratic Equation** questions were **easy to solve.**
- 2 questions from **Wrong Number Series** questions were **easy** and 2 were **time-consuming.**
- Data Interpretation Questions:
  - One DI set with 5 questions was **table-based** and **calculative**, moderate in difficulty.
  - Another DI with 4 questions was based on a **caselet**, which was **easy to solve**.
- **No questions** were asked from **Partnership, Time & Work, Simple Interest,** and **Percentage**. However, don't skip these topics, as they are still important.
- Consistent practice is key to improving your **speed and accuracy**.
- Solve a variety of questions from **different topics** to enhance your **problem-solving skills.**
- Practice solving previous year papers and take **multiple mock tests** within a time limit to improve your speed and time management.

7.1.2 Quantitative Aptitude

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 quant difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Quant Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	6
Moderate	12
Difficult	2
Total	**20**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 quant topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Quantitative Aptitude Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Data Interpretation	9
Quadratic Equations	4
Number Series	2
Compound Interest	1
Mixture & Alligation	1
Profit & Loss	1
Ages	1
Number System	1
Total	**20**

C. Key Takeaways

- The overall difficulty level of quant in 2024 was **moderate**, with only 2 difficult questions.
- Around 50% of the quant questions come from **data interpretation** (DI).
    - These types of questions are **time-consuming** and come in a set of **4 to 5** questions.
- **Quadratic Equation** questions were **easy to solve**.
- 2 questions from **Wrong Number Series** questions were **easy** and 2 were **time-consuming.**
- Data Interpretation Questions:
    - One DI set with 5 questions was **table-based** and **calculative**, moderate in difficulty.
    - Another DI with 4 questions was based on a **caselet**, which was **easy to solve**.
- **No questions** were asked from **Partnership, Time & Work, Simple Interest,** and **Percentage**. However, don't skip these topics, as they are still important.
- Consistent practice is key to improving your **speed and accuracy.**
- Solve a variety of questions from **different topics** to enhance your **problem-solving skills**.
- Practice solving previous year papers and take **multiple mock tests** within a time limit to improve your speed and time management.

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7.1.3 English

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 English difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 English Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	10
Moderate	7
Difficult	3
Total	**20**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 English topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 English Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Reading Comprehension	7
Fill Ups	5
Error Detection	4
Rearrangement	4
Total	**20**

C. Key Takeaways

- The SEBI Grade A 2024 English exam was **easy to moderate** in nature.
- A maximum of **7 questions** were asked from Reading Comprehension (RC), which was lower compared to 10 questions in the 2022 exam.
- The RC passage was based on the **presence of humans beyond Earth and its challenges.**
- No questions were asked from **Cloze Test, Odd One Out, Double Fillers, and Idioms and Phrases.**
- Overall, the paper was **doable** within the given time limit.
- English was the **most scoring** section among QRE (Quantitative, Reasoning, and English).
- Focus on **grammar, vocabulary, and comprehension** to ace this section.
- The Comprehension was easy to solve, with **direct and factual** questions. The rest of the exam mainly focused on **vocabulary and grammatical** sections.
- **Practice MCQs** and take **mock tests** to boost your performance and score well in this section.

7.1.4 General Awareness (GA)

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 General Awareness (GA) difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 GA Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	10
Moderate	6
Difficult	4
Total	**20**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 GA topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 GA Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Government Schemes	4
Finance Static	4
First in News	2
Sports	2
Awards	2
Places in News	2
Finance Current Affairs	2
Reports And Indices	2
Total	**20**

C. Key Takeaways

- GA questions were moderate in difficulty level.
- The majority of questions were from Government Schemes, so prioritize studying these, especially those related to SEBI.
- No lengthy, statement-based questions were asked, making the section less time-consuming and easier to solve.
- Questions were straightforward and easy to tackle, particularly for candidates with a basic understanding of finance.
- Most questions were from 3 to 4 months old current affairs, with a few questions from 5 to 8 months old.
- To improve your knowledge, regular mock tests are essential for assessing your preparation and identifying areas to work on.
- Stay updated by solving daily or weekly current affairs quizzes.

7.1.5 Management

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Management difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Management Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	6
Moderate	3
Difficult	0
Total	**9**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Management topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Management Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
General Management	4
HRD	3
Communication	1
Leadership	1
Total	**9**

C. Key Takeaways

- The overall **difficulty level** of the **SEBI Grade A Phase 1 Paper 2 Management section** was **easy.**
- Most questions were from **General Management**, which can be easily solved if your **basic concepts** are clear.
- **No questions** were asked from **Motivation.**
- Focus on **understanding the concepts** rather than just cramming information.
- Take **regular mock tests** to assess your knowledge and identify areas that need improvement.

7.1.6 Finance

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	7
Moderate	3
Difficult	1
Total	**11**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Bonds	3
Primary and Secondary Market –Equity Market	2
Primary and Secondary Market –Debt Market	2
Financial Institutions	1
Financial Inclusion	1
Basics of Derivatives –Futures, Forwards, and Swaps	1
Functions of SEBI	1
Total	**11**

C. Key Takeaways

- The **Finance** section in the SEBI Grade A Phase 1 Paper 2 exam is **moderate** in difficulty.
- The majority of questions (11) in the exam were from **Finance**, so it's essential to pay extra attention to this section.
- In **2024,** there was a noticeable shift toward **Debt Market, Bonds**, and **Financial Inclusion.** Make sure you allocate enough time to these topics in your preparation.
- Topics like **Functions of SEBI** and **Basics of Derivatives** have remained consistent, so don't overlook them.
- **Basics of Derivatives (Options)** and **Mutual Funds** were not covered in the **2024** exam, but you should not ignore these topics.
- Maximum (3) questions were asked from Bonds, so make sure you understand the concepts thoroughly.
- Regularly take **mock tests** and solve **sectional questions** to improve your understanding and speed in Finance topics.

7.1.7 Commerce and Accountancy

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	4
Moderate	2
Difficult	0
Total	**6**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Fund Flow Statement	1
Cash Flow Statements	1
Ratio Analysis	1
Recording Transaction	1
Presentation and Preparation of Final Company Accounts	1
AS for PPE	1
Total	**6**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Commerce and Accountancy section was **moderate** in difficulty.
- Only **6 questions** were asked from Commerce and Accountancy in SEBI Grade A Phase 1 Paper 2, the **least among other sections**.
- These 6 questions were spread across **6 different topics**, with no two questions from the same topic.
- There were fewer **numerical questions** in the accounts and costing sections, a noticeable change compared to the 2022 exam.
- There were **no questions** on topics like Introduction to Accounting, AS for Revenue Recognition, Accounting for Buyback of Shares, and Accounting for Bonus Shares—topics that were included in the 2022 exam.
- There were only **2 repeated topics** from previous exams:
    - Presentation and Preparation of Final Company Accounts
    - AS for PPE

- Ensure a strong understanding of **basic accounting principles**, financial statements (Balance Sheet, Profit & Loss), and key concepts like cash flow statements and ratio analysis.
- **Solve numerical problems** regularly, particularly in areas that are often tested.

7.1.8 Costing

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	5
Moderate	2
Difficult	0
Total	**7**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Lean System and Innovation	3
Overview of Cost and Management Accounting	1
Standard Costing	1
Marginal Costing	1
Activity-Based Costing	1
Total	**7**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Costing section was **easy**, with no particularly difficult questions.
- Questions were **straightforward** and easy to solve if you have a basic understanding of core concepts.
- A **maximum of 3 questions** were asked from **Lean Systems and Innovation**, which is half compared to the previous 2022 exam, where 6 questions were asked on this topic.
- **3 questions** came from topics that were not tested in 2022:
  - Standard costing
  - Marginal costing
  - Active based costing.
- **No questions** were asked from Budget and Budgetary Control, Labour Cost, and Material Cost. However, don't ignore these topics in your preparation, as they could still be relevant in future exams.
- Focus on **memorizing and understanding the application** of formulas for marginal costing, standard costing, and budgetary control.
- Practice a wide range of **numerical problems** to improve both your speed and accuracy in solving costing-related questions.

7.1.9 Companies Act

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	10
Moderate	0
Difficult	0
Total	**10**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Chapter IV Share Capital and Debentures	3
Chapter XII-Meeting of Board of Directors	2
Chapter XXVII –NCLT and NCLAT	2
Chapter X –Audit and Auditors	1
Chapter VIII Declaration and Payment of Dividend	1
Chapter XI Appointment and Qualifications of Directors	1
Total	**10**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Companies Act section was easy in nature.
- No questions were asked from Chapter III – Prospectus & Allotment of Securities.
- A maximum of 3 questions were asked from Chapter IV – Share Capital and Debentures.
- No new topics were included that weren't present in the 2022 exam.
- The subject is highly factual, so it's important to focus on memorization.
- The best strategy is to read the law, revise the key sections and facts, and memorize them.
- Create concise notes to simplify complex sections, making them easier to recall during the exam.

7.1.10 Economics

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	3
Moderate	3
Difficult	2
Total	**7**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Inflation and Phillips Curve	2
National Income	2
Demand and Supply	2
IS-LM Model	1
Total	**7**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Economics section was relatively easy.
- No questions were asked from Market Structures, Elasticity of Demand, and Balance of Payments, which were included in the 2022 exam.
- The questions are generally conceptual, with little focus on technical graphs or numerical solving. The emphasis is on understanding core economic principles.
- Economics questions in SEBI Grade A are mostly theory-based, but the depth and framing can vary each year.
- Focus on the core principles of micro and macro-economics.
- Familiarize yourself with recent economic surveys, budgets, and reports, as these are frequently the basis for questions.

7.2 SEBI Grade A Phase 2 2024 Exam Analysis

The SEBI Grade A 2024 Phase 2 exam was conducted on **31 August 2024**.

Based on the analysis, we can say that the overall difficulty level of the SEBI Grade A 2024 Phase 2 exam was **moderate**.

Each question in this section, except for Descriptive English, carries **1 mark** each.

7.2.1 Descriptive English

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Descriptive English difficulty level

SEBI Grade A 2024 Descriptive English Difficulty Level	
Type of Questions	**Questions**
Essay	Moderate
Precis	Moderate
Reading Comprehension	Moderate
Overall Difficulty Level	**Moderate**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Descriptive English topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Descriptive English Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Essay	1 topic to be chosen out of 4
Precis	1
Reading Comprehension	5
Total	**7**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Descriptive English paper was **moderate** in difficulty.
- **Essay:**
  - You were given **4 essay** topics and had to attempt only one.
  - A significant change in 2024 was the strict word limit of **250 to 270 words**, a shift from the previous open-ended approach with a minimum of 250 words.
  - The topics were varied and thought-provoking, including:
    - ESG Norms
    - Management
    - Banks & Social Healthcare
    - Machines vs. Humans
- **Precis:**
- The passage, titled "**Evolution of the Gaming Industry since 2000**," was longer than in previous years.
- The word limit for the precis was also specific, requiring a summary of **140 to 160 words.**
- **Reading Comprehension:**
- The passage was titled "Dawn of Social Influence" and discussed the rise of social media influencers.

- It was recommended to write 70-80 words for each answer.

- To succeed in this section, **practice writing descriptive answers regularly**.
- This will help you build the skill to clearly and effectively **express your views** within the given word limits.

7.2.2 Management

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Management difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Management Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	13
Moderate	4
Difficult	0
Total	**17**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Management topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Management Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
General Management	9
Motivation	3
Communication	2
Leadership	2
HRD	1
Total	**17**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Management section was **easy** overall.
- All the questions came from the same topics that were asked in the **2022 exam**.
- A maximum of **9 questions** were asked from **General Management.**
- Questions were based on **core management theories**, including **Theory Z** and **Victor Vroom's Theory.**
- This section had a mix of **easy and time-consuming** questions.
- Focus on the **foundational theories** of management, including motivation, leadership, and organizational behaviour.
- Pay attention to **key terminology** and the concepts they represent, as this is often tested in multiple-choice questions.

7.2.3 Finance

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	9
Moderate	5
Difficult	3
Total	**17**

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B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Finance Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Equity Markets	3
Direct and Indirect Tax	1
FRBM Act	1
Finance Commission	1
Time Value of Money	1
Derivatives	1
Debt Market	1
Forex Market	1
Financial Inclusion	1
Financial Risk Management	1
Budget	1
Misc (CA)	4
Total	**17**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Finance section was **moderate**, with only 3 difficult questions.
- Finance questions were **easy** to solve with a solid understanding of **finance fundamentals**, especially when compared to the **2022 exam**, which was more calculation-heavy and time-consuming.

- **No questions** were asked from **Financial Institutions** and the **Functions of RBI**.
- **New topics** covered in 2024 that weren't part of the 2022 exam include **FRBM Act, Time Value of Money, Derivatives,** and **Equity Markets.**
- Build a strong foundation in **financial markets, corporate finance, and risk management.**
- Stay updated with **current financial news** and developments, as questions often connect theory to **recent events.**
- Practice **previous year questions (PYQs)** and take **mock tests** to improve your speed and understanding.

7.2.3 Commerce and Accountancy

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	12
Moderate	4
Difficult	1
Total	**17**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Commerce and Accountancy Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Ratio Analysis	3
Accounting for Bonus Shares and Rights Issue	3
Theoretical Basis of Accounting	2
Introduction to Accounting Standards	2
Accounting Standard for Foreign Exchange Transactions	1
Cash Flow	1
Accounting for Share Capital	1
Introduction to Accountancy	1
Financial Statement Analysis and Fund Flow System	1
Out of Syllabus	2
Total	**17**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Commerce and Accountancy section was generally **easy**, with only 1 difficult question.
- **Topics Covered:**
  - Most questions were based on **fundamental theoretical concepts**, like Accounting Standards, Cash flow statement, Fund flow statement, Share Capital Transactions, etc.
  - **Numerical questions** were **simple** and didn't require a calculator. Focus on mastering basic **calculations**.
  - The maximum number of questions were from **Ratio Analysis** and **Accounting for Bonus Shares and Rights Issues**, with **3 questions each.**

- **Topics Not Covered:**
  - **No questions** were asked from **Accounting Standards for Inventories** and **Property, Plant, and Equipment**, which were part of the **2022 exam**.
  - **Other topics** that were not covered in the past two exams, but you shouldn't ignore, include:Recording Transactions (Part 1 & 2)
  - Trial Balance
  - Bills of Exchange
  - Income Statement
  - Balance Sheet
  - Accounting for ESOPS
  - Accounting for Buyback of Shares
  - Accounting Standard for Investments
  - Accounting as a Financial Information System
- Stay focused on understanding **basic theoretical concepts** and **simple numerical problems.**

7.2.4 Costing

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	6
Moderate	8
Difficult	1
Total	**15**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Costing Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Number of Questions**
Marginal Costing	3
Overview of Cost and Management Accounting	2
Material Cost	1
Process or Operating Costing	1
Overhead Costing	1
Standard Costing and Variance Costing	1
Lean System and Innovation	1
Out of Syllabus	3
Miscellaneous	2
Total	**15**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Costing section was **moderate** in difficulty level.
- The maximum number of questions were asked from **Marginal Costing**, with **3 questions**.
- **Numerical questions** were straightforward and **formula-based**, with specific mention of the **PV ratio formula.**
- **No questions** were asked from **Budgeting** and **Labour Cost**, although these topics were included in the **2022 exam**.

Over the past two exams, **no questions** were asked from the following topics:

- Activity-Based Costing
- Output or Unit Cost
- Job Costing & Batch Costing
- Contract Costing
- Joint and By-Product Costing
- Service Costing

- **Numerical questions** were asked **less** compared to the **2022 exam**, so concentrate on basic costing formulas and improve your speed in solving them.

7.2.5 Companies Act 🏢

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	13
Moderate	5
Difficult	1
Total	**19**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Companies Act Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Chapter IV Share Capital and Debenture	4
Chapter XXVII –NCLT and NCLAT	3
Chapter X: Audit and Auditors	3
Chapter VIII Declaration and Payment of Dividend	2
Chapter XI Appointment of Directors (sections 149 to 160)	2
Chapter XI –Appointment of Directors (Section 161 to 172)	1
Chapter XII –Meeting of Board of Directors (Section 173-183)	1
Chapter XII –Meeting of Board of Directors (Sections 184 to 195)	1
Chapter III –Prospectus & Allotment of Securities	1
Out of Syllabus	1
Total	**19**

C. Key Takeaways

- The Companies Act section was **easy**, with only 1 difficult question.
- The **maximum** number of questions was asked from the Companies Act subject in the SEBI Grade A Phase 2 Paper 2 exam.
- The **highest number of questions (4)** was from Chapter IV – Share Capital and Debentures.
- Questions were also asked from Chapter XI – Appointment of Directors (Section 161 to 172) and Chapter XII – Meeting of Board of Directors (Section 184 to 195), which were **not covered in the 2022** exam.
- Questions were **fact-based** and focused on **specific sections** of the Companies Act.

7.2.6 Economics

A. Difficulty Level

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics difficulty level:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics Difficulty Level	
Difficulty Level	**Questions**
Easy	6
Moderate	8
Difficult	1
Total	**15**

B. Topic-Wise Weightage

Here is the SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics topic-wise weightage:

SEBI Grade A 2024 Economics Topic-Wise Weightage	
Topic	**Questions**
Inflation and Philips Curve	4
Fiscal Policy	2
National Income	2
Monetary Policy	1
Market Structures	1
Consumption & Investment FN, Multiplier & Acc.	1
Balance of Payments	1
International Financial Institution	1
Out of Syllabus	2
Total	**15**

C. Key Takeaways

- The questions in the Economics section were generally **easy to solve**.
- Most of the questions were based on **definitions**, so having a clear understanding of basic economic concepts will help you solve them easily.
- The **maximum** number of questions (4) were from the topic Inflation and Philips Curve.
- **No questions** were asked from topics like Demand and Supply, Elasticity of Demand, and Non-Banking Financial Companies, which were part of the 2022 exam.
- Compared to 2022, questions were asked from **new topics** like Consumption & Investment FN, Multiplier & Acc., Balance of Payments, and International Financial Institutions.
- Focus on understanding key **economic laws** and **theorems** to answer theory-based questions.
- Practice **Previous Year Questions (PYQs)** to get a feel for the exam pattern.
- Take **time bound mock tests** to assess your weak areas and work on improving them.

Part 8

SEBI Grade A Preparation

8. Preparation

Understanding what to focus on is important, but picking the right study resources can take your preparation to the next level.

8.1 Resources for Each Subject

Below are the best books and resources for SEBI Grade A preparation.

1. **Quantitative Aptitude Books for SEBI Grade A**
   - How to Prepare for Quantitative Aptitude for CAT by Arun Sharma
   - Quantitative Aptitude for Competitive Examinations by R.S. Agarwal
2. **Reasoning Ability Books for SEBI Grade A**
   - A Modern Approach to Verbal and Non-Verbal Reasoning by R.S. Agarwal
   - Analytical Reasoning by M.K. Pandey
3. **English Books for SEBI Grade A**
   - Objective General English by S.P. Bakshi
   - Word Power Made Simple by Norman Lewis
4. **GA Books and other Resources for SEBI Grade A**
   - News and Notifications of RBI, SEBI, PFRDA, IRDAI, Finance Ministry
   - Weekly/Monthly Current Affairs Compilations/PDFs
   - Banking Awareness by Arihant Publication
   - The Hindu
   - Press Information Bureau
   - Livemint
   - SEBI Website
5. **Commerce & Accountancy Books for SEBI Grade A**
   - 11th Class Accounts NCERT Part 1 and 2
   - 12th Class Accounts NCERT Part 2
   - **Students guide to Accounting Standards** – Dr D.S Rawat
   - **ICAI** Knowledge Portal: Intermediate Course

6. **Management Books for SEBI Grade A**
    - Principles and Practice of Management – LM Prasad
    - Organisational Behaviour- LM Prasad
    - Human Resource Management – LM Prasad
    - Principles and Practice of Management – TN Chhabra
    - **Management Study Guide (Website)**
7. **Finance Books for SEBI Grade A**
    - Principles and Practice Of Banking – IIBF
    - Indian Financial System- Bharati Pathak
    - Bank Financial Management – IIBF
    - Indian Economy – Ramesh Singh
    - Websites: **Investopedia**, Latest **Economic Survey,** and **FAQs** On RBI website
    - Livemint
8. **Costing Books for SEBI Grade A**
    - Cost Accounting: Principles and Practice – M.N. Arora
    - Modern Cost and Management Accounting – M. Hanif
    - Paper 8, 10, and 15 of Intermediate Study Material on ICMAI
9. **Companies Act Books for SEBI Grade A**
    - Companies Act, 2013 (Make it Simple by AUBSP)
    - PDF/EBook of Companies Act 2013 (given on MCA)
10. **Economics Books for SEBI Grade A**
    - Indian Economy by Ramesh Singh
    - Principles of Microeconomics – HL Ahuja
    - Macroeconomics Theory and Policy – HL Ahuja
    - IGNOU Notes

Important Note: As the syllabus of the SEBI Grade A Phase 1 Paper 2 and Phase 2 Paper 2 is **the same**, so are the books and resources. So, you can refer to the above-mentioned list for the books and resources for both Phase 1 Paper 2 and Phase 2 Paper 2.

All the above resources are not to be read cover to cover. You must refer to the syllabus as well as the previous year's questions and then do the selective reading.

8.2 Resources for Interview Preparation

If you have read the pattern of SEBI, then you would be aware that the weightage of the interview is 15%, which indicates the interview is going to be more about your analytical skill and your perception about the external world.

So, these are the 7 key areas you need to focus on for the interview.

8.2.1 Detailed Application Form (DAF):

DAF is the most important tool for your interview because it tells the panel members about you and helps them judge you.

If you have prepared at least 100 questions on your DAF including family background, educational qualification, gap years if any, low % in academics, etc. really well, you will be very easily able to turn the interview in your favour.

Also, while filling your DAF, you should avoid some of these common mistakes -

- Always give professional references so that they can vouch for your competitiveness and intelligence.
- Following a random order for filling educational qualifications
- Not giving honest reasons for leaving the previous job. You need to be honest yet careful while filling this section, as in you may write that for better career prospects you left the job but saying that you left the job because your boss was pathetic can-do harm.

8.2.2 Know about SEBI:

The interviewer of any organization expects you to know at least a bit about the organization.

To know about SEBI, the About section, Annual reports, Press releases containing recent developments in SEBI and Speeches on the SEBI website are more than sufficient.

The interviewer may not ask direct questions but you can always use the information collected over the time to frame your answers in the interview.

8.2.3 Make yourself Stand Out:

Your answers will look more real & practical if you have ground knowledge. You can gain this knowledge by visiting some stock exchanges and interacting with people there or by simply observing people working there.

You can do some NISM you can do some NISM certifications that take hardly 3-4 days.

Read some books by Ex- SEBI officials, for eg., Going Public by U.K.Sinha and A Game Changer's Memoir by G.N.Bajpai, because these books will give you great insights about how SEBI works, what are the challenges, how SEBI has transformed, etc. and incorporating what you learn in your answers will certainly fetch you some extra marks.

8.2.4 Current Affairs:

Current affairs can be covered through Livemint and SEBI website.

The questions asked in the interview are mostly open-ended where they may ask you “What is recently in News about SEBI?” so basically if you know any News about SEBI thoroughly you will be able to answer this question.

More than facts, reasons & implications behind any action are most important. So, current affairs with any 1 standard newspaper can be managed very easily.

8.2.5 Static syllabus:

Direct questions from the static part are rare in the interview. However, they may ask questions about the basics of the Capital Market and regulations of the Capital Market.

Regulations are important because SEBI is a capital market regulator so the panelist may expect you to be aware of some basics of these regulations.

8.2.6 Mannerism in Interview:

Knowledge is important, but your personality plays a vital role in creating your impression. Mannerism includes -

1. **Dress Code**
2. **How to Enter & Exit the room**
3. **How to make optimal eye contact**
4. **Right Body Language for Interview**
5. **Right Sitting Posture for Interview**
6. **Right Hand Movement during Interview**
7. **How to handle stress**
8. **How to say 'I Don't Know' to a Question?**
9. **How to politely disagree if at all you need to disagree**

8.2.7 Mock Interview:

Mock interview helps you test yourself. It stimulates your thought process.

For e.g., the questions asked in the mock interview may be on different lines which you might have not even thought of.

It gives you firsthand experience, but only if you take a mock interview with an experienced panellist.

8.3 300-Hour SEBI Grade A Study Plan

This plan is in hours so you decide how many days or months each subject will take. Multiply daily hours × days to reach the subject total.

You can fit 300 hours into 60 days (5 hrs/day), 90 days (3.3 hrs/day), or any timeline you prefer. Keep ~20 extra days as buffer for revision, mocks, or slips.

SEBI Grade A 300 Hours Study Plan	
Subject	**Hours**
Management	40
Costing	40
Finance	40
Company Law (selected chapters)	40
General Awareness	30
Revision	30
Accounts (selected portions)	20
Economics (selected portions)	20
Quantitative Aptitude (selective)	20
Reasoning (selective)	20
Total	**300**

8.4 SEBI Grade A: Subject-Wise Strategy

8.4.1 Management

- Core syllabus topics: Management principles, Leadership, HRD, Motivation, Communication.
- Also cover **(not listed in syllabus but asked earlier):** Recruitment & Selection; Training & Development; Career Planning; Performance Appraisals; Counselling.
- Memorise keywords and trivial facts (e.g., Maslow's five needs). Practice many MCQs.

8.4.2 Costing

- 4 main units:
    1. Overview of Cost & Management Accounting (cost types)
    2. Costing methods — job, batch, contract, process, unit costing; costing for service sector
    3. Cost control — marginal costing, standard costing, budgeting
    4. Lean systems & innovation (waste reduction, defect reduction techniques)
- High-priority: Cost sheet, marginal costing / CVP analysis, material & labour variances, process costing (abnormal loss, equivalent production).
- Practice numerical problems thoroughly (Phase 1 had some numericals; Phase 2 had more).

8.4.3 Finance

- Unit A: Roles & functions of regulatory bodies (RBI, SEBI, NABARD, PFRDA etc.)
- Financial markets (money, bond, equity, forex) and instruments (derivatives, futures, forwards, swaps); basics of mutual funds.
- Financial inclusion, alternate finance (crowdfunding, PPP).
- Taxation basics (GST), Fiscal Policy, FRBM, Finance Commission.
- Time value of money basics; simple numerical practice for bonds/derivatives where required. Prioritise Unit A & core topics.

8.4.4 Company Law (selected chapters only)

- Mandatory chapters to cover: Ch. 3 (Prospectus & Allotment), Ch. 4 (Share Capital & Debentures), Ch. 8 (Dividends), Ch. 10 (Audit & Auditors), Ch. 11 (Appointment of Auditors), Ch. 12 (Qualification/Appointment of Directors), Ch. 27 (NCLT & NCLAT).
- Focus on facts and numbers (limits, thresholds, who can remove/appoint whom, key section numbers).
- Paper tends to be fact-based — memorise key provisions, section numbers, and factual details.

8.4.5 Economics (selected)

- Prioritise Unit B content (relatively easier): Balance of payments, Forex, inflation, monetary & fiscal policy, non-bank financial institutions.
- From Unit A pick: Inflation, business cycles, demand & supply of money — basic conceptual clarity.
- Avoid deep academic dives; focus on concept clarity and common exam-level questions.

8.4.6 Quantitative Aptitude & Reasoning (Paper 1 focus)

- Quant: Simplification/Approximation, Number series, Quadratic equations, DI (ratio & percentage basics). Target ~10 marks. Practice ~100 Qs from selected topics.
- Reasoning: Focus on Coding-Decoding, Syllogism, Blood relations, Direction, Puzzles/Arrangement styles prevalent in recent tests. Target ~10 marks.

8.4.7 General Awareness

- Continuous daily practice: current affairs, finance sector news, static facts relevant to SEBI and regulatory functions.
- During the final phase increase to 2 hrs/day as revision.

8.4.8 Accounts (selected)

- Cover selected portions only (after Phase 1 if self-prepping). Focus on topics that have appeared previously. Practice end-of-chapter problems in recommended books.

8.5 Revision strategy

- **Daily recall:** after studying a topic, close notes and recall key points aloud or write them. This strengthens permanent memory.
- **Parallel revision:** revise daily, again after one week, and after one month (1-1-1 rule).
- **Weekend deep revision:** invest 5–6 hours on weekends for consolidation.
- Solve lots of MCQs as part of revision — MCQs act as both practice and revision.

8.6 Mock test strategy

- Do **full-length mocks only after 70–80% syllabus completion**.
- **5 full-length mocks** are suggested.
- Leave **1 day gap** between mocks for analysis (e.g., Mon mock → Wed mock).
- Give mocks as **one full exam day** (Paper 1 + Paper 2 back-to-back) to simulate actual conditions.
- Analyse each mock thoroughly before the next one; focus on weak topics revealed by analysis.

SEBI Grade A

Preparation Tips
Customize Study Plan
Manage Time Allocation
Practice Mock Tests
Revise Regularly
Stay Motivated
Focus on Conceptual Clarity
Stay Physically Active

What Next?

This guidebook has equipped you with the essential information that can help you understand the SEBI Grade A exam and how to crack it. Here are some tips that can further help in your exam preparation.

- **Analyze Previous Year Papers:** Analyze the PYQ papers to understand the exam trends and the type of questions asked. Failing to do so might leave you unprepared for the diversity of questions that could be posed during the exam, putting you at a disadvantage.

- **Practice Mock Tests:** Regularly practice mock tests to simulate exam conditions. This helps improve time management, accuracy, and familiarity with the exam format. Without regular simulation of exam conditions, you may encounter challenges in managing your time effectively during the actual exam.

- **Focus on Weak Areas:** Solving mock tests and analyzing PYQs help you identify your strengths and weaknesses. Now you can allocate more time to strengthen your weak areas. Regularly assess your progress and adapt your study plan accordingly.

- **Supplement Your Resources:** Do not stick to only one resource for preparation. It is recommended to always supplement your preparation with additional resources for overall preparation. However, do not go overboard with it.

- **Make Notes:** Take detailed notes summarizing key points, essential concepts, and important facts to ensure retention. This will serve as a quick reference during revision.

- **Stay Positive and Motivated:** Maintain a positive mindset throughout your preparation. Surround yourself with supportive individuals and believe in your ability to succeed.

By following these recommendations and leveraging the resources provided in this guidebook, you can significantly enhance your chances of becoming an SEBI officer. Remember, the key is to stay focused, committed, and persistent on your path to success.

We at EduTap wish you the very best in your SEBI Grade A Exam preparation.

EduTap

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We are a passionate team of experienced professionals who understand the challenges of aspirants preparing for government jobs. Our vision is to "***create a nurturing ecosystem for the aspirants so that they can feel safe, guided, and mentored***."

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We empower students to achieve their goals through comprehensive guidance, expert mentorship, and a supportive community. From a humble beginning in 2016, we have grown to serve over 6 lakh learners, consistently producing top results in Regulatory Bodies Exams (RBI, NABARD, SEBI), IIBF Certification Exams (JAIIB and CAIIB), and UPSC Civil Services (CSAT).

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Our courses offer a **comprehensive curriculum** that covers all aspects of the exam, from theoretical knowledge to practical application.

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We help you connect with a **community of like-minded individuals** who share your goals and support your journey.